

# AROUND THE WORLD

While you were busy cursing peak traffic, here's what made news in the auto world.

## ASTON MARTIN LAUNCHED A 'LIGHTWEIGHT' DB11

**T**he British luxury sports car maker has introduced a new variant of the DB11, which happens to be a drop-top convertible. While the DB11 Coupe was powered by a V12 engine, Aston Martin decided that this was making the car too heavy, and it wasn't 'light' or 'sporty' enough in handling. The replacement, a lighter V8 engine, produces 510 brake horsepower and nearly 700Nm of torque only.



The company claims that this change has indeed affected the car's handling, and it will be much more nimble-footed to drive down winding coastal hill roads. We'd love to put their claim to test, but it's not yet clear if the Aston Martin DB11 V8 Volante Convertible will come to India. Anyway, it should cost at least upward of ₹4 crore, so we suggest you begin saving up already.

Link: <http://dgit.in/AstMDB11>

## THE DUBAI POLICE NOW HAS A 'HOVERBIKE'

**I**f the local police force near you had Bugattis, Lamborghinis and Bentleys in its fleet to chase down law-breakers, would you even think of speeding up that extra bit, ever? If you still did, the Dubai Police has a new mode of disarming you - on a hoverbike. The venerable police fleet, which is now famous for its marketing initiatives behind acquiring these supercars, released a video declaring the procurement of the Hoversurf Scorpion hoverbike.

We're not entirely sure if this thing is practical (or even safe), it appears to ride like a motorbike, and can fly through

the air - hence, hoverbike.

Additional reports suggest that it is all-electric, can fly at up to 70kph for 30mins with a load of about 275kg.

Oh, and yes, it can be deployed in autonomous mode.

Link: <http://dgit.in/>

DubHovb



## LAND ROVER HAS ROLLED OUT ITS FIRST-EVER HYBRID VEHICLE

**T**he Range Rover SUV now has a hybrid variant - the Range Rover P400e. The SUV gets a combination of a 2-litre, 300bhp petrol engine, along with a 116kW electric motor, combining to produce 403bhp. The SUV also gets 50 kilometres of electric-only driving range, and a host of modes to adjust power delivery. One such mode is Predictive Energy Optimisation, where if you input the destination of your journey to the car, the drivetrain automatically adapts the power delivery to balance between electric-only, hybrid and combustion-only.

The Range Rover Hybrid also comes with the company's Touch Pro Duo infotainment system, which replaces the old buttons with touch panels. Add that to a minor facelift, and you have the first Range Rover of the future!

Link: <http://dgit.in/LandRovr>



## FERRARI IS REPORTEDLY MAKING...AN SUV!

**I**t is still a bit hard to conceive that the supercar and Formula One legend will ditch the performance car design, even for once, to build something that focuses on utility instead of sheer speed.

But reportedly, according to the internet, Ferrari is building an SUV. Reports also suggest that Ferrari will eventually strive to find a way to retain the sports car factor, even in a utility vehicle. The 'confirmation' that has come is that Ferrari will declare its plans only around 2020, behind this SUV.

Until, then, it's all rumours. But, one such rumour has suggested that if and when Ferrari does build a rather burly car, it will be called a 'Ferrari Utility Vehicle'. FUV. Yeah. That's going to be one cool abbreviation though.

Link: <http://dgit.in/FerSUV>

